Lipfty - How to play

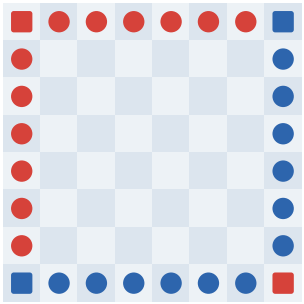
Rules for Lipfty 16.0.1 | Experimental rules | 13 October 2026

A two-player strategy game with shared pieces. Neither player owns a colour. Usually your opponent chooses your piece; you decide how to use it.

1. Setup

Use an 8 x 8 board. The inner 6 x 6 is the playing area and starts completely empty. There is no Opening Four.

Put 24 ordinary round pieces, 12 Red and 12 Blue, on the six non-corner cells of each outside edge in any order. Put ONE shaped special at each physical corner: two Red and two Blue in total. Use other distinct colours if preferred. Choose a starter.



Empty inner 6 x 6

24 ordinary pieces

4 shaped specials

ONE at each corner

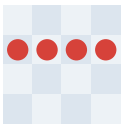
2. Winning and game versions

Learning: Place only; four of one colour in a horizontal, vertical or diagonal line wins.

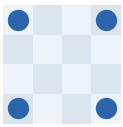
Easy: Place, Move and Jump; the same line wins apply.

Standard: Easy plus four of one colour at the corners of an axis-aligned square, tight or spaced. Its sides must be equal and parallel to the board edges. Intervening spaces need not be empty.

The player completing the pattern wins, whatever its colour. Check after EVERY placement, Move, Jump and redeployment. A win ends the game immediately, cancelling any remaining compulsory placements. All inner squares can count towards wins from the start.



Line: all versions



Square: Standard

3. Normal turns

While ordinary reserves remain, the opponent selects an ordinary piece for the player taking the turn. Corner specials cannot be chosen instead.

Place: put the selected piece on any empty inner square.

Move (Easy / Standard): move an unpinned board piece of the handed colour one adjacent square in any of eight directions to an empty square. Hold the selected reserve piece for the consequence.

Jump (Easy / Standard): jump an unpinned piece of the handed colour over one adjacent opposite-colour, unpinned piece into the empty square beyond. One jump only. Keep the jumped piece for redeployment.

You cannot Move or Jump the exact piece protected by the opponent's previous Move or Jump. After an ordinary placement, choose the next ordinary piece for your opponent.

4. First placement: Accept / Take position

After the first ordinary placement, the other player decides: Accept and play next, or Take position and make the original starter play next. The placed piece stays where it is. Colours remain shared.

Click the flashing first placement to Take position. Click an available ordinary reserve to Accept and select that exact piece for your next turn. The Accept button uses the normal starter-chooses route.

5. After a Move

If the Move did not win:

1. The mover holds the originally selected ordinary reserve piece.

2. The opponent chooses and places another ordinary reserve piece, of either available colour. The held piece is unavailable.

3. The mover places the exact held piece.

4. Normal play resumes with the opponent taking the next turn.

If the held piece is the LAST ordinary reserve, the opponent instead chooses and places a remaining corner special; the mover then places the held ordinary piece. A Move requires a second placement source to exist.

Worked example: you are handed Red and Move an ordinary Red board piece. Your opponent chooses Blue from the ordinary reserve and places it; you then place your held Red. Both consequence actions are Place only.

Then TWO placements

Opponent first; mover second

Hold the selected reserve until its placement.

6. After a Jump

If the Jump did not win:

1. The opponent chooses between the exact held reserve piece and the removed jumped piece, and places one.

2. The jumper places the other exact piece.

3. Normal play resumes with the opponent taking the next turn.

Worked example: you are handed Red and Jump a Red board piece over Blue. Your opponent may place the held Red or removed Blue; you place the other. No extra piece is taken from a corner.

Jumped pieces are redeployed, never permanently captured. Consequence actions are Place only. After a Move or Jump, the moving piece is protected through the consequence and the opponent's following normal turn.

Then TWO placements

Opponent first; mover second

Jumped Blue is redeployed.

7. Special pieces and the endgame

Ordinary outside pieces always take priority for a free reserve choice. Do not choose a Red corner merely because ordinary Red has run out while ordinary Blue remains.

During a consequence, preserve the exact held and jumped pieces. A corner supplies the opponent's placement after a Move only when no other ordinary reserve remains.

Once every ordinary reserve has been placed and any consequence is complete, the current player chooses and places a remaining corner special themselves. They do not hand it to the opponent.

Specials are ALWAYS placement-only: selecting one never permits a Move or Jump. Once placed, their distinct shape marks them as permanently pinned. They count towards wins but cannot Move, Jump or be jumped over.

In this experimental version, ordinary Move/Jump remains available even when only one ordinary reserve colour remains. When only specials remain, all turns are Place only.

If a compulsory placement has no legal piece or destination, it is a draw. Otherwise, if all reserves are used and every compulsory placement is complete without a win, it is a draw.

8. Clock, highlights and Undo

With the optional chess clock, running out of time loses. Available pieces pulse in their own colour; the selected source flashes more strongly. Unavailable specials are pale. Dots show legal destinations. Select a board piece for Move/Jump dots; select it again for placement. Animations off uses steady highlights.

Undo restores position and clock, including after a result, reverses that result in statistics, and returns to a human decision against the computer.

Play: https://blarm1959.github.io/Lipfty-App/